

3.1.7 Area of study 6: Contemporary traditional music

For the purpose of this specification, contemporary traditional music is defined as music influenced by traditional musical features fused with contemporary elements and styles.

Named artists

- Astor Piazzolla
- Toumani Diabaté
- Anoushka Shankar
- Mariza
- Bellowhead

Musical elements

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section C (Essay) of the exam. Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms, if relevant to this area of study, in section C (Essay) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• raga • pitch bend • kumbengo (ostinato riffs on kora) • birimintingo (improvised runs).
Harmony	• drone • sus4 chords • chord symbols eg C/E, C⁷, C^ø and C⁺ • other added notes – eg 2nd, 6th, sus4.
Tonality	• specific modes eg Dorian, Lydian.

Element type	Element
Structure	• tango nuevo, milonga • fado • alap • fusion • verse and chorus • folk rock • song form/standard form.
Sonority (Timbre)	• specific instruments: bandoneon, kora, sitar, Portuguese guitar • specialist string techniques for tango, including chicharra, latigo, arrestre and tambor • studio effects eg reverb, sampling • piano glissando • drone • sympathetic strings (sitar).
Texture	• looping • layering • heterophonic.
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• polyrhythm • latin 3 + 3 + 2 rhythm • habanera rhythm • tala • riff.